DOCUMENT 6

FLOW AUTOMATION GUIDE - CERTIFICATE SUPPORT

Introduction to ServiceNow Flow Designer

ServiceNow Flow Designer is a powerful 'Low-code' automation tool. It enables users to create and monitor workflows rapidly. In the ABC Corporation project, this is the core engine used to eliminate manual ticket assignments and enable the system to take autonomous actions. Since it utilizes a 'Natural Language' interface, even non-developers can easily understand and manage the flow logic.

Benefits of Low-code Automation

- Speed: Automation can be taken 'Live' quickly as there is no requirement for manual coding.
- Accuracy: It ensures error-free assignments by eliminating human errors.
- Visibility: Every step of the process can be tracked in real-time using the 'Flow Execution' view.
- Cost-Effective: By reducing administrative time and manual labor, it significantly saves operational costs for the organization.

Flow Creation - 'Regarding Certificate'

Steps to create a new flow:

1. Filter Navigator: Type "Flow Designer" and open the module.
2. New Flow: Click on the 'New' button and select 'Flow'.

3. Flow Properties:
    - Name: Regarding Certificate.
    - Application: Global.
    - Run as: System User (This helps avoid permission-related issues during execution).
4. Submit: Click submit to initialize the flow canvas.

Trigger Logic - Record Created/Updated

The trigger determines when the flow should start its execution:

- Trigger Type: Record.
- Trigger Condition: Created or Updated.
- Table: u_operations_related.
- Logic: Whenever a new ticket is created or an existing ticket is updated in this specific table, the flow will trigger automatically.

Condition Builder - Setting 'Issue is Regarding Certificates' (Part 1)

The condition acts as the 'Filter' for the flow. Not every ticket should be handled by this specific flow:

1. Add a Trigger Condition: Go to the 'Condition' section.
2. Field: Select the Issue field.
3. Operator: Select is.
4. Value: Select Regarding Certificates.

Condition Builder - Setting 'Issue is Regarding Certificates' (Part 2)

The subsequent 'Action' will only execute if this condition is met.

- Advanced Criteria: To maintain system performance, you can add a condition like 'Active is true' to ensure the flow only processes active records. This prevents the system from wasting resources on closed or inactive tickets.

Action Logic - 'Update Record' Action Configuration

What should happen once the condition is successfully matched?

1. Add an Action: Click and select 'Update Record' from the 'ServiceNow Core' section.
2. Record: Link the specific record that came from the trigger step.
3. Fields to Update: Select the 'Assigned to group' field for modification.

Data Pill Picker - Mapping Fields for Automation

Data Pills serve as the 'Variables' within the flow:

- Mechanism: Use the 'Data Pill Picker' to drag and drop the 'Operations related record' from the trigger step into the 'Update Record' step.
- Accuracy: This ensures that the system maps the data from the exact same record, maintaining data consistency throughout the automation.

Assignment Logic - Auto-routing to 'Certificates' Group

This is the critical automation step:

- Field: Assigned to group.
- Value: Certificates.
- Logic: If the conditions are met, the group field of that ticket is automatically changed to 'Certificates'. Immediately, Katherine Pierce (Manager) and her team members will receive an automated alert.

Flow Error Handling & Retries

In case of errors during flow execution (Error handling):

- Error Handler: Activate the 'Error Handler' section at the bottom of the flow.
- Action on Error: Configure an action to send an email notification to the administrator if the flow fails.
- Retry Logic: If the system is busy, the flow can be configured to retry the execution after a specific interval.

Testing the Flow with Sample Records

Before moving to the live environment:

1. Test Button: Click 'Test' within the Flow Designer.
2. Select Record: Choose a sample record from the u_operations_related table (where Issue is 'Regarding Certificates').
3. Run Test: Click 'Run Test' and monitor the execution status.

4. Verification: Check the actual table record to confirm if the assignment group has been updated correctly.

Flow Activation & Version Control

1. Save: Save the flow configuration.
2. Activate: Click 'Activate' to make the automation live in the system.
3. Version Control: When making future changes, always keep a backup of the previous version.
4. Conclusion: ABC Corporation’s certificate support system is now 100% automated and ready for efficient, rapid operation.